

Knowledge Representation

Stefan Schlobach

With slides from

Frank van Harmelen

Who am I?

- Stefan Schlobach
- Studied CS in Saarbrücken and Paris
- PhD in Logic from University of London, King's College
- Associate Prof at VU, co-leading a group of ± 15 researchers
- Knowledge Representation, Semantic Web, Knowledge Graphs, Knowledge Engineering

Examples of intelligent behaviour?

carry out complex reasoning
(solve physics problems,
prove theorems)

draw plans

(diagrams)

use natural language

“but we do not mean that people can recognize familiar objects,
or execute motor skills, or navigate around space,
abilities we share with dogs and cats (and fish)”

conversations

solving novel complex problems
(generating plans,
designing artifacts)

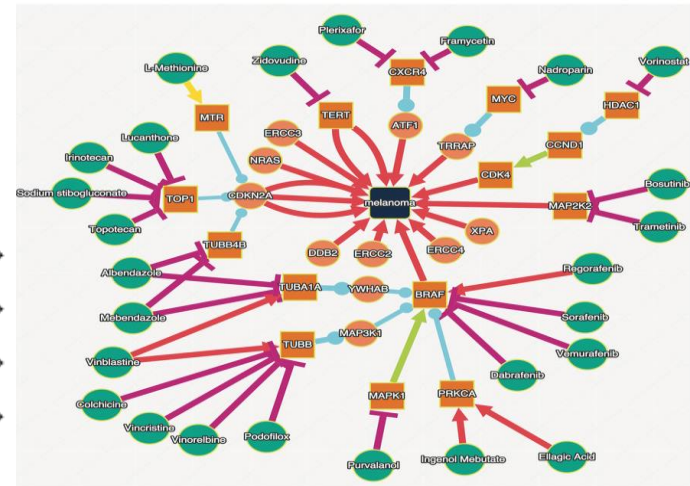
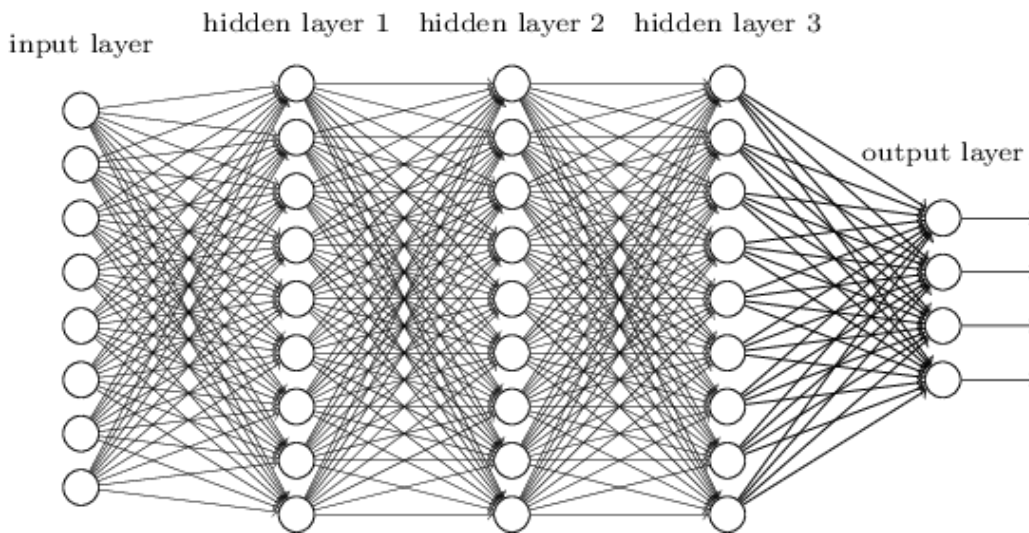
But isn't modern AI all about Machine Learning ?

Two main lines of development in AI

- symbolic representations
- statistical representation

There have been alternating cycles of one dominating over the other in different decades of the history of AI.

Statistical vs. Symbolic



Rule: IF someone has dysphagia THEN that person may have esophageal cancer

someone

Variables

has dysphagia

Condition

that person may have esophageal cancer

Conclusion or Action

A stairway?

statistical
Data
Statistics
Learning

Symbolic
Knowledge
Logic
Reasoning

A pendulum!



statistical
Data
Statistics
Learning

Symbolic
Knowledge
Logic
Reasoning

A GOOD JOB.

Statistical vs. symbolic AI: very different types of applications

statistical:

- pattern recognition (images, sound, shapes)
- motor skills (robots)
- speech generation (sound)
- search engines

symbolic:

- planning (autonomous space missions)
- reasoning (diagnosis, design, decision support)
- language generation (conversations beyond Q&A)
- search engines

Audience participation...

Who was his predecessor?

KR

Who was his predecessor's predecessor?

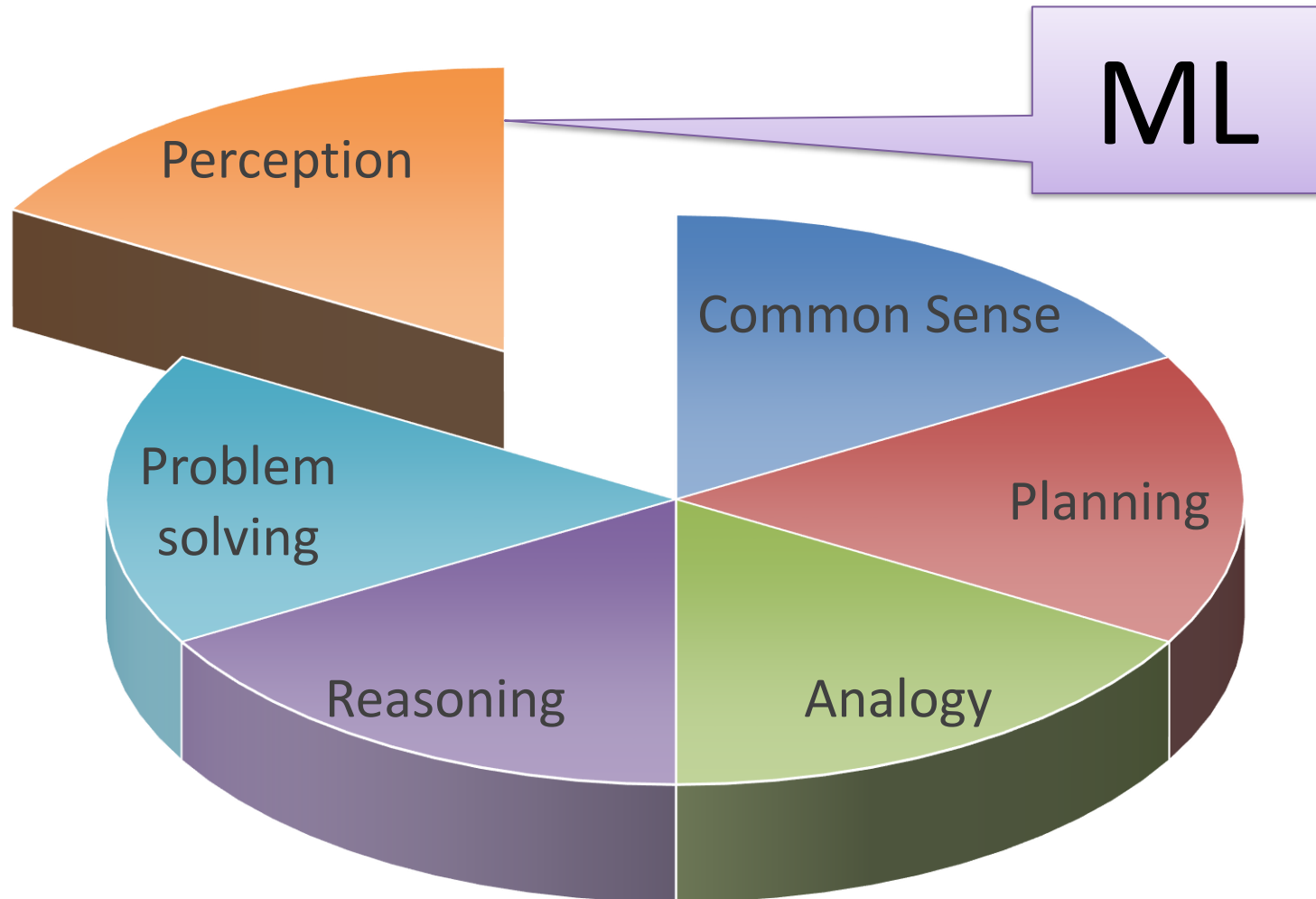
Thinking
slow

Thinking
fast

ML



Human intelligence = thinking fast & thinking slow



Thinking fast without thinking slow

Class: 793

Label: n04209133 (shower cap)

Certainty: 99.7%



& Weaknesses

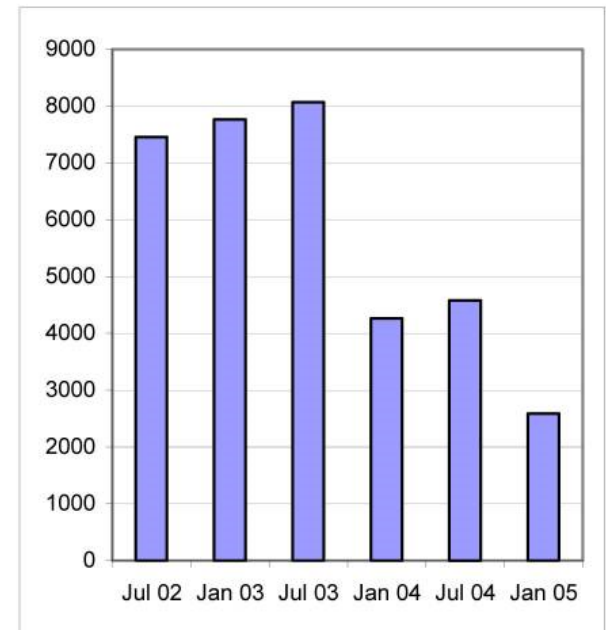
	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff

Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff

SNOMED CT
The global
language of
healthcare

300.00 definitions
40 years of effort,
10.000 updates every years



Strengths & Weaknesses



☐ This one



☐ This one



4.8M training games

Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff

worse with
more data

worse with
less data

Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff

Rule: IF someone has dysphagia THEN that person may have esophageal cancer

someone

Variables

has dysphagia

Condition

that person may have
esophageal cancer

Conclusion or Action

Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff



“panda”
55%

+



=



“gibbon”
99%



Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff

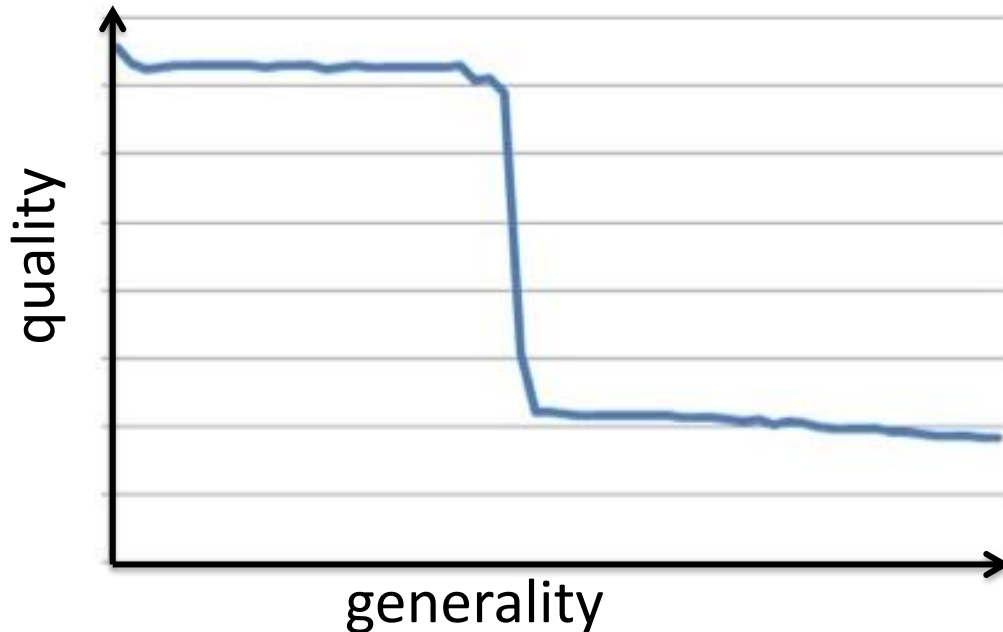


=



Strengths & Weaknesses

	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff



Strengths & Weaknesses

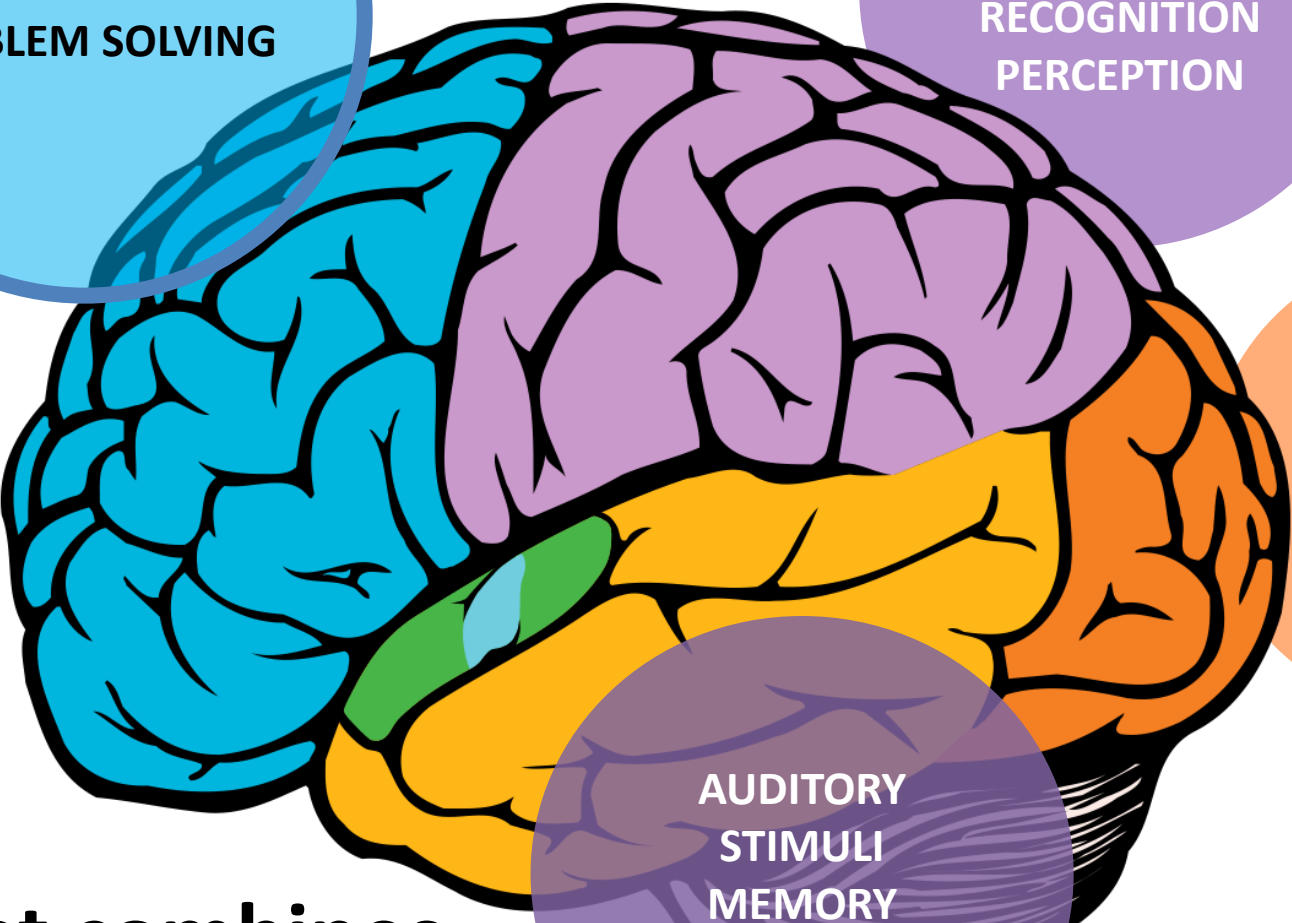
	Symbolic	statistical
Construction	Human effort	Data hunger
Scaleable	+/-	+/-
Explainable	+	-
Generalisable	Performance cliff	Performance cliff



Class: 793

Label: n04209133 (**shower cap**)

Certainty: 99.7%



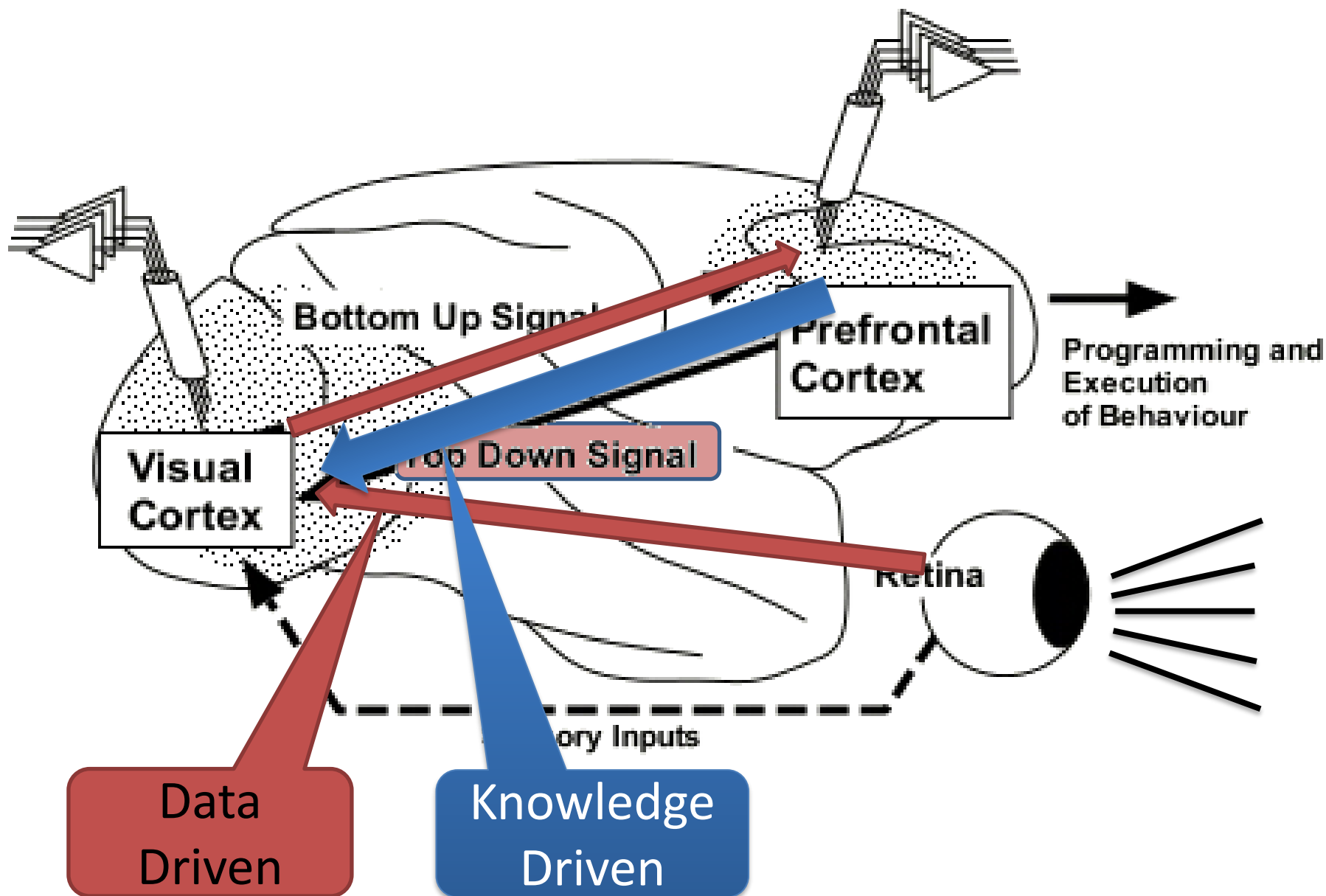
**REASONING
PLANNING
PROBLEM SOLVING**

**MOVEMENT
ORIENTATION
RECOGNITION
PERCEPTION**

**VISUAL
PROCESSING**

**AUDITORY
STIMULI
MEMORY
SPEECH**

**AI that combines
all the parts of our brain**



Wanted:

AI that combines all the parts of our brain

Learning (Fast)	Reasoning (Slow)
Better with more data	Worse with more data
Needs lots of data	Already works with very little data
Not explainable	Explainable
Robust against noise	Brittle with noise

Handbook of Knowledge Representation (1000 pages, ToC alone is 14 pages)

- propositional logic & satisfiability solvers
- first order logic & resolution
- description logic
- constraint (logic) programming
- nonmonotonic reasoning
- belief revision
- qualitative reasoning
- model-based diagnosis
- bayesian networks
- temporal logic
- spatial reasoning
- epistemic logic
- deontic logic
- situation calculus
- default logic
- event calculus
- **knowledge graphs**
-

